The New/Old NA Way



Volume 54 - December 2023



The New/Old NA WAY Magazine
Volume 54 - December 2023
This magazine was written in open participation by
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members of the Groups who participate in the
Fellowship Service Conference and the
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The New/Old NA Way

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With Others
The NA Way

Path of Surrender

First there was nothing but fear, anxiety, insanity and despair. Addiction was running rampant in the family. I was hiding everything inside. Uncried tears and unscreamed screams was crippling my heart and blurring my vision.

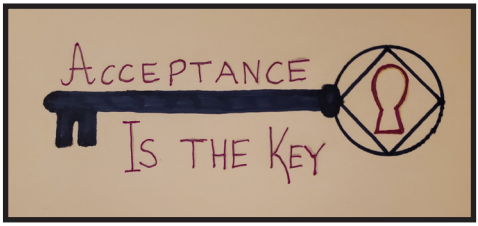
Then one day in the woods back of the house I was offered something to drink. It tasted like dirt but it felt like heaven. It seemed like it erased all pain and sadness. The same potion that was destroying my home was giving me a feeling of relief and happiness. I needed more, much more.

In the end it was nothing but suffering, my body was black and blue from slowly committing suicide. I couldn't stand another fix, and still I was dying for another fix. When I was ready to die, I opened my heart to a Higher Power without a name nor limits. I was suddenly surrendered by divine grace and there it was, a path of surrender and recovery.

Been walking that path for 2297 days now.

Love you all.

An anonymous addict from Sweden



Productive member

If you read our literature you will quickly read about being a productive member of society. In Narcotics Anonymous we believe that it is possible to become once again productive, and a member of society.

Productive

Being active!

What does our literature say about being productive?

"Productive means being clean, creative and loving today." Grey Book page 123.

It means giving up our complacency and becoming vigilant in maintaining an atmosphere of recovery, in our Group and in our interactions with other NA members. We need to keep growing and need to look at ourselves and how we affect the atmosphere around us. Are we just trying to control the outcomes of whatever is going on around us? Or are we allowing ourselves and others to be creative and loving today? Trying to control breaks creativity and opens the door for negativity. This is not productive for whatever we try to do together. If we think we know best what is good for the Fellowship, our Group and others we separate ourselves.

Member

Getting off the bench, start playing!

We can make a decision to become part of Narcotics Anony-

mous, and even join a Homegroup where we can start to give back. We can give back in many ways. By doing service, giving our time, energy and money, and being there for the other members and newcomers. We learn to give our fair share.

We learn about the principles of our way of life by becoming a productive member of a Group. This means stepping away from the sideline we've been hiding on for so long. It means to stop talking, blaming and controlling, and start doing. No words are necessary when we start to put action in that helps others, the Group and the Fellowship grow. It speaks for itself. It is gratitude in action when we start to give back. We have been given a new way of life, but it's not a gift that comes without responsibility. It is also not something we have been given and can now try to control in the way we think is best. We can be a member if we allow others to be so too, it means practicing tolerance, and acceptance. NA gives us a place in this world, and we need to take care of it. From there we start to grow and become part of the Society we belong to.

Society

Giving back!

In NA we learn to stop our rebellion towards others, organizations, governments, the world around us or anything that we blame for our own fear. We grow in faith through the Steps and learn to take our place in the world, regardless of what is going on around us. Only in this way are we able to be useful to others and the Fellowship. If we live from fear, we will look for ways to control, and force our own found solutions on others because it enforces our belief in them. This is a seductive cycle that drives us from our faith, disguising itself in self righteousness. We become blind for our controlling ways that prevent us from finding real serenity and gratitude, that comes from accepting our place in society, and simply being a part of what is going on in our lives, in our Groups and in our Fellowship. We can not be productive when our lives are controlled by fear.

We have our place in the world, and the Steps help us to find it and be grateful for it. In NA we learn to stop resisting our place and to become responsible for it. We want to be free, and part of freedom is being able to be responsible. We learn how to become responsible for our place in the world, and to not depend on others to take care of that place. This means being responsible and taking care of ourselves and the ones we are responsible for.

The real reward is freedom, and we start to experience self worth and a sense of belonging when we finally stop living for ourselves and become a productive member of our Group, our Fellowship and our society.

An anonymous addicts from The Netherlands

No Excuses

Why would you stop doing something that gave you everything you wanted during your active addiction, that you felt you were losing? If your relationships with your spouse, a child, a job with better hours and pay, a little bit of better mental focus's all improved? The Grey Book tells us, Insanity! When I joined NA, I joined because my life was unmanageable. I was mentally, and spiritually broken. My wife and I were in the midst of an on and off again separation. My 13-year-old was telling me hates me under his breathe, he still does from time to time. I was struggling to decide if I wanted to stay at my job, the only place I felt loved and supported since we relocated states. I could start but couldn't finish projects for my hobbies. My creative juices were not flowing, no matter how much or little used. I felt exhausted, and hopeless.

I started my recovery journey in another fellowship. I had made the decision to go there, on my own. Not for my kids who I would leave to their own devices longer than need be, while I sat in my car and used. Not for my wife, who would often come home to smell of whatever I was using in our bed. I didn't start practicing surrender while her mentors, friends, work colleagues, and clients, relapsed and died around her. Why? Because I've tried that. On my own. Over and over again. I didn't know how. All I knew was that during this separation time, as I moved myself downstairs was my time to work on me.

Before finding NA, I read a lot of self-help books, and listened to a lot of podcasts on time management, time blocking, motivation, reworking your brain. There is nothing wrong with a lot do those books. The problem was my addict brain. The problem I would later learn was that my way doesn't work. I also learned that this is a program of suggestions. In doing so, I was able to find a level of peace and calmness. In making calls to fellow addicts, I found humility. By attending meetings, I found hope. In joining Zoom meetings, I found new recovery friends with similar hobbies and aspirations. A new support system for my personal goals. In taking daily inventory I started to find me.

Over the past week I found myself falling back into old habits of self-pity, fear, and letting past emotional abuse effect my focus. I picture it like a closed door. The first negative thoughts stress saving the knob. By not taking my daily inventory, which always center me. I allowed the door to slowly crack open. Once that happens it's like a free for all. Day after day I start obsessing over ever negative thought. They come faster and after, one after another. Until it seems they are moving through memories in chronological order at light speed. I was still making calls; I was even jumping on meetings

during my lunch break at work. What happened?

I was not writing my inventory. I didn't call my sponsor two days in one week. I was making excuses. I became self-deceiving. Being deceived is one of the things that I hate the most in life. Yet I was doing it to myself. By telling myself just finish this task, or you can fit writing in after something else, or before you go to bed. There is no excuse for not writing a daily inventory.

Others have shared many of times when we stop surrendering to the program, that's when are disease gets to work. It's like the door. Addictions sticks its foot in the crack of the door, right next to the jamb. It allows why we worked so hard towards to quickly unravel. I don't want to go back to the insanity of my past. Even though I didn't have the desire to use, this time. I know from other addicts that we we make excuses it is a relapse waiting to happen. Luckily for us this is a just for today program. As I lay in bed let lay night, I prayed, I meditated, and I took a good, honest inventory. After that I called my sponsor, with no excuses. Today I feel better than I have the last few days, a feel that I can truly live in the moment.

An anonymous addict from Ohio

BLAST FROM THE PAST

Through looking glass at the EFSC 2022

For some of us it was the first time at EFSC. We didn't know what to expect. The welcoming was very great and warm. Meeting people from different areas, and different countries. All suffering from the same illness. Entering the group, we could immediately feel the group vibe - the Fellowship. Sitting together at the open fire was great, special, and spiritual. The experience of "Godfather" Bill A. was a great example for many of us, more than 40 years clean, never used again. That is something we also want. Talking with Fellows during the day we could again and again recognizing our common experience.

One addict shares,

Last year I expected the EFSC to be only build on having fun. Connecting with each other and some meetings. After I felt the energy put in the days from all the groups, all over the world who came to Hunsel to think about how to reach the still suffering addict and see all the fellows cracking their brain, just to reach newcomers who still didn't find or know the fellowships and the meetings. My heart melted last year!

That was the point I made the decision to come the next year, and

attend all of the days, and do my best to do something back for the fellowship and have the best 4 days of the year. This year I experienced that having the connection with each other all day long, sharing experiences, strength and hope cost a lot of mental energy but it's definitely A loving feeling of the the higher power. I wish everyone could enjoy and experience this connection and knowledge I did in the few days im here

For those of us that's been to the conference before, it can be a real blessing to meet all of our friends again. We come here to learn from one another, to laugh and cry together. It's a conference of Spirits.

We see members from different parts of the world sharing their love for Narcotics Anonymous. Some members visit the couch and leave with insomnia and spiritual awakenings.



The experience of another addict:

"Two months ago, i decided to definitely quit using drugs. I went to the NA meetings and learned about the EFSC 2022. I didn't knew what it was so i searched on the internet. And saw that it's a "Fellowship Service Conference" and my first thought was "oh it's not for me because I'm not doing 'service' (at the moment).

I experienced already another 4 days with 60 fellows and that was amazing. So, I asked again at my meeting if it's only accessible for people who do 'service'. "Nooooo, everybody can come as long as their clean. So, i decided to have this experience.

Yesterday (the 15th of September) it started from 14:30. At 13:00 i started to pack my stuff. We could choose between a bed to sleep inside a group accommodation or a tent. I arrived with a tent and put it on the most beautiful place! Next to a water, a view of trees and a wooden swing, hanging on a tree. That i loved already Very much.

Other fellows arrived and the vibe was excited, it felt like a school camp when I was 14 years old. People I never met worked together and I could feel the unity. We opened the weekend with an opening circle where everybody could introduce his-or herself. And there was a BBQ with vegan and animal hamburgers. Nice to come together that way.

In the evening we had a meeting at the campfire. also, very nice and connected.

What I liked the most is the free way and unconditional love. We have one thing in common "addiction" and understand each other without words. To feel the group connection between people from Sweden, Germany, UK, The Netherlands and even USA is amazing. For me, let's make a reservation for next year!

Another addict shares their experience of the EFSC:

"I was invited by the Miracle Group from Venlo and i didn't know what to expect. I came to the place where the EFSC was starting and I felt immediately at home. Everybody was so nice, kind and social. Also helped everybody get together with the camping site and questions. What was most impressive to me was that everybody introduced themselves and hugged.

Now I am here on my second day and I was a very big experience so far. With a lot of laughter and sometimes a tear. It is heart opening to hear others history and changes what the NA meetings has meant for them and since a little while for me. Also, the care for each other.

I am very thankful that this came on my path. I think it is because off the higher power that is watching over us as we are willing. I will make sure i won't miss this next year. Thank You all for that is making this happen."

Another addict's experience:

"I'm happy to be here. It's my second time at the EFSC. It's so much more comfortable than the first time and it feels like coming home. I therefore was surprised to be very nervous when I had to introduce myself. After a very hard time committing to the program, especially the five tools, I'm trying to participate as much as possible. I only have a hard time with the lack of sleep. Because of that I take naps during the day. This gathering and great fellowshipping makes me want to commit more to the program again. I enjoyed the part where a newcomer competed if he was the oldest present with 55. Totally missing the fact prehistoric Bill is here also."

We are addicts so new experiences are always scary to us. This was no different when we came to the EFSC for the first time. Through the Steps and the faith, we have in a Higher Power we did things that are extraordinary for us and wasn't possible in active addiction. For example, introducing ourselves or reading a Group report, but meeting new people is the biggest thing we've conquered this weekend. Because of we were insecure by nature we were scared of new people and the emotions that the anxiety brings. We notice that we haven't felt lonely for a moment. It doesn't matter to us if we are with 60 Fellows, there's one thing we have in common, our addiction.

We became grateful that we still

were teachable and could learn from the experience from Fellows. The service we do for the EFSC is special to us, because NA gave us the opportunity to experience total abstinence. We can give back through service which for us is a great way to stay humble.

An anonymous addict

An Essay on the Eighth Tradition

"Narcotics Anonymous should remain forever nonprofessional, but our service centers may employ special workers." Let's take a look at what this tradition is telling us. In the 3rd Edition Revised it says, ""Service centers may employ special workers." This statement means that service centers may employ workers for special skills such as phone answering, clerical work, or printing." Our lowest level service committee, NAW$, has gone far beyond our fellowship's understanding of special workers. By utilizing staff writers to create our literature, NAW$ stands in clear violation of the spirit of the 8th Tradition. I have often heard addicts say that "they only edit and compile our ideas". In response to that, let me quote from Lee Manchester's resume. Lee was a staff writer for the WSO from October 1987 thru December 1996 (I am not breaching any confidence here; his resume is on the internet for all to see).

"Nearly three quarters of a million copies of my books for Narcotics Anonymous are in print. I co-authored and edited most of the new membership and organizational literature adopted by Narcotics Anonymous during my tenure at the World Service Office, including three full-length books and a revamped service manual for every level of the organization. " Notice the term co-authored.

"Just for Today: Daily Meditations for Recovering Addicts" (1992). I wrote a little over a quarter of the entries myself and was editorial supervisor for the 3 other writers on the project. Completed in 5 months. "I wrote a little over a quarter of the entries myself"?

It Works: How and Why" (1993). After watching four unsuccessful attempts over a period of 10 years to develop a book on NA's Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, I created an editorial process that produced copy quickly and inexpensively and that the organization could feel comfortable with. I wrote more than a quarter of the text myself, editing the rest. "I wrote more than a quarter of the text myself"?

Also, in the 3rd Rev. it says, "In this Tradition we say we have no professionals. By this, we mean we have no staff psychiatrists, doctors, lawyers, counselors, etc. Our program works by one addict helping another." I don't know about you but I have been

counseled by our literature many times. Here are several other quotes from Lee's resume:

"My "African Drug and Alcohol Bibliography" is published among the full-text documents on the Virtual Clearinghouse site of the Canadian Centre on Substance Abuse. This listing of 307 bibliographic references and 70 abstracts was first presented at an August 1995 symposium on addiction research in developing countries conducted by the Kettil Bruun Society for Alcohol Research."

""Twelve-Step Program" (1995). I was commissioned to write this 500-word article on the 12-step movement for Collier's Encyclopedia."

I would say these qualify Lee as an addiction professional.

Our text says, "Many of our problems are like those our predecessors had to face. Their hard-won experience gave birth to the Traditions…" so let's see what our predecessors say. AA has a long version of the traditions as well as a short one, which we've adapted. The last line in the long version of the 8th Tradition says, "But our usual A.A. "12th Step" work is never to be paid for." If you look at how our text was written, that was 12th step work at it's finest. Did you know that NAW$ employees travel the world assisting in the development of NA in other countries, doing PI work and promoting NA? In the Grey Form, the original review and input version of the text, it says, "The professional has no place in our Fellowship; our very nature prohibits this." and "It's just that there's no place for professionalism in N.A.; for our purpose we have learned the therapeutic value of one addict helping another is truly without parallel.". True service in NA arises from a 12th step.

This brings us to the question of motivation. I don't care how spiritual a person might be, there are always days when the only reason you work is because it is your job and you have to. Here is an excerpt from the NA Way of Life on the 8th Tradition:

"…. but what about editing and writing literature? Doing Public Information, Hospital and Institution work, etc.? Should paid workers travel and assist in the development of NA in other areas? These are questions that have arisen in regard to the Eighth Tradition. We need to look at the concept of "special workers" in light of our Steps and Traditions. While we may employ people to do day to day tasks in our service centers, 12th Step work or "carrying the message" should result from our gratitude and spiritual awakening, not from desire for personal gain. Our motivations are important. We only keep what we have by giving it away. The strength of our message is as much in the giver as the message itself. It is spiritual and this tradition helps us to divide the spiritual from the material. The Eighth Tradition can keep us from sacrificing our spiritual principles for the sake of material efficiency."

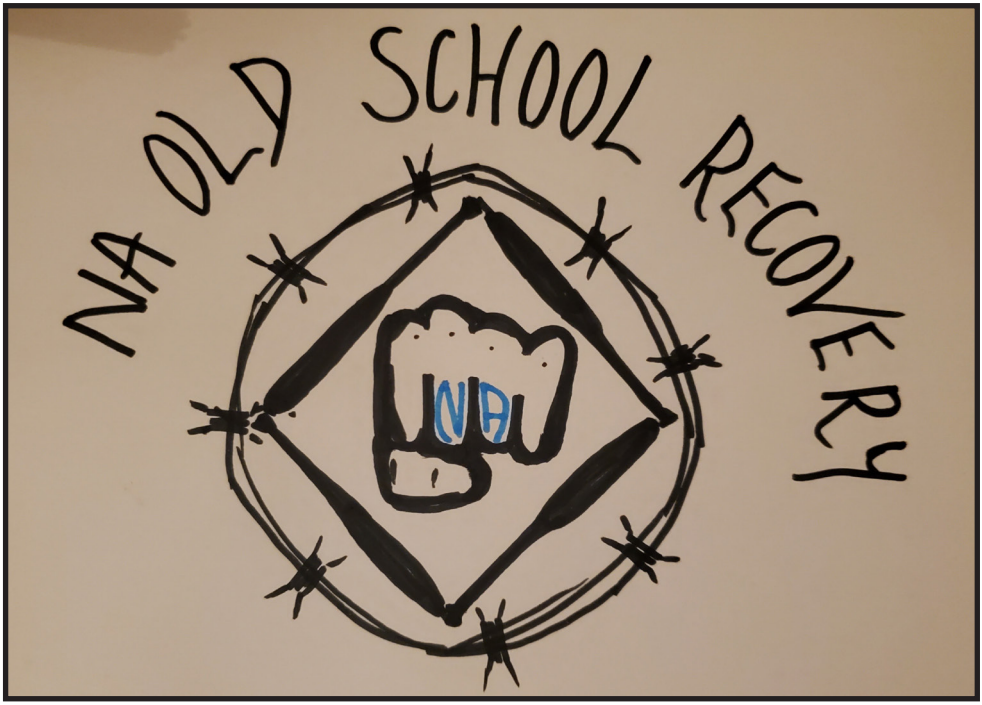
Material efficiency, corporations

strive for material efficiency. But Narcotics Anonymous is a spiritual fellowship and our service used to reflect our spiritual principles and values at all levels. For the last 12 years or so a corporate mentality has been flourishing in NA service. With this new emphasis on "leadership", espoused by the 12 concepts, we are in a situation where in order to do "volunteer" service at the world level, a resume must be submitted and pass a "Human Resources Panel". If this sounds unbelievable, go to www.na.org and click on the World Pool links. I believe we are all faced with a decision. Are we OK with the corporate direction of our service or do we want to return to a spiritual, group conscience driven service structure? Ignoring the issue is the same as agreeing with the way things are being done. When the 12 concepts were being introduced did anyone really think about what they meant or what the consequences might be? It's time for all of us, on a grass roots level, to educate ourselves and weigh all our decisions in light of our spiritual values.

Thank you, your humble servant, an anonymous addict from Florida.

PS I will be happy to provide copies of Lee's full resume to any who request them as well as documentation to all claims above.

From an anonymous addict in Florida



Hearts

Hearts in a circle sharing bonds of empathy, recovery, and unity creates an even bigger heart with the power to bring a flatline back to pulse.

Hearts in NA bleeds into a river of service and guides the suffering back home.

Hearts in NA pumps blood of gratitude and can be reflected in the twinkle of an awakened eye.

Hearts in NA can't survive on chemicals, they need spiritual principles to keep pumping clean blood to the drum of a Greater Power.

Hearts in NA beats together in every hug, every smile, every tear, and every Group Conscience sprung from of the love for the still suffering addict.

Hearts in NA won't stay silent. Every heartbeat is a signal of hope to the still suffering addict.

There's no room for money, ego, property or prestige in pure hearted servants of Narcotics Anonymous. There's only unconditional love and loyalty to a Greater Power who bleeds through all of the Program.

Addiction cannot penetrate the heart, it resides in the mind. It might just be that the 12 Steps are a pathway into the heart.

Let your heart shine through your actions and keep listening to the whispers of the still suffering heart crying for help.

By an anonymous addict in Sweden

Step 1

A week and a half ago I was at the meeting and we were talking about patterns. When we talk about that, I always think that I don't see patterns in my writing, but since I've expressed that, I'm suddenly starting to see patterns in my behavior.

I see more and more when I write my Step 1 inventory, that I've either already written about this before or I've been doing it for a long time. That also the same things keep coming back again and again it seems. I also see how I react to certain things and that that is actually also always in the same way and usually not the most healthy way of course.

Furthermore, I really see that I am powerless over what affects me, when certain things happen and that I actually react to them automatically, usually with anger. That always comes first and I only see later what is actually underneath and that is usually sadness. Sometimes I really feel like a small child in the things I am affected by, but also how I react or want to react to them.

Fortunately, writing my inventory helps me with this and I see that it is actually always something from the past. I am getting to understand more and more why I react the way I react and what is underneath. I also see how my illness controls me in this and always wants me to a lonely place and also that my first reaction to things is actually always destructive. Fortunately now I have a choice and I don't have to react and I notice when I don't it all gets a lot quieter in my head. I still have a long way to go, but I have regained a little more confidence that if I keep following this path, things will work out.

An anonymous addicts from The Netherlands



THE ADVENTURES OF SIR RENDER

SIR RENDER CALLS THE NA TEAM




Yes! We are on our way
Wait.. what..?
I did not even say anything
Beeb Beeb
THE NA TEAM
But i..
NOW!
Get in the van!
I love it when a plan comes together
Yeah. Get them fools to a meeting.
THE NA TEAM
NA
THE END..

Acceptance and Surrender are the Cornerstone of Our Journey

Acceptance and Surrender are the Cornerstone of Our Journey. With each new day, we are given many opportunities, opportunities in which we do not know the results of them as we cannot see that which has not come yet. With acceptance and surrender as the cornerstone of our journey, we find that our battles become less and less as recovery is gradual. We find the opportunity to enjoy the gifts of our program. We become content with or without those things that we want for this I have found that all things that I want are not good for me or my recovery, or perhaps I have not matured enough to appreciate these gifts.

This contentment comes as a result of our faith and our willingness to find that acceptance in the process in which life on life's terms presents to us. Not everything we seek in life and the journey that we are on is not meant to be. How often do we forget that we can't see past the very end of our nose, yet we continue to attempt to guide our recovery and live in denial often placing blame on others, our failure to accept personal responsibility is an indication that pride and self-will is our guide, and yet we said God take my will and my life guide me and my recovery and show me how to live. Slow to learn, fast to forget that in which we have been shown. Be content with today's gifts as we never know what God's plans are for us, yet I know that his plans truly are better than anything that I can come up with. Be patient, for if it is meant to be, it will manifest itself in God's time, not yours,

Just for today, I will not blame others for my actions or events that just did not turn out the way I want them to, for this I know that God's plans for me and others are truly better than anything that I can come up with.

In Service
An anonymous addict from Michigan

Consistency and Renewed Commitment to Radio Free NA

"By not accepting personal responsibility we were creating our own problems." That sentence has been a thorn in my side lately. Also, Jimmy K sharing in his dream speech about being a "shyster" and not taking the "direct approach." While using I was always looking for something to fix me. Even while clean it has become apparent our disease can manifest itself in different ways other than using.

My whole life has been chaos. Some of it I truly appreciate. It is a

defect of character that needs dealt with. It must be let go with love or it will consume me. I've seen how consistency changes everything. Everyone that have talked with that has gone any period of time without using has said that the longer they don't use they see progress. It has definitely been that way in my life.

There are lots of excuses I can come up with why I am where I am, but it all really comes down to that first sentence. Now as I want to make change it seems I am looking for any way to stay busy except doing the things I need to do to accept that personal responsibility.

It is time to face myself and let myself go. Time to give this to God and learn how to be responsible in all areas of my life. I know God will grant me this as it has been seen in other areas.

While taking my own inventory it was apparent that I have been avoiding things a lot lately. Some of those things are also being consistent on radiofreena@groups.io. So that commitment is being renewed today. A commitment to at least 10 posts a day with one article a month at least. Also committing to some personal things as well each day that are part of accepting my personal responsibility for my life. Consistency has never failed in helping change happen. Time to find that consistency in these areas of my life as well.

An anonymous addict from Nebraska



Happiness is an Inside Job

Happiness is an inside job. Want to feel good? Do good!! Stressed out? Help someone else!!

The disease feeds on self-centeredness. Self-centeredness, usually in the form of self-centered fear, does not make for happy joyous and free. But, good news, we have a whole set of principles to move the needle in the right direction; our twelve steps particularly to walk us there. No accident that S12 principles are Selflessness, Unconditional Love and Service-work... applying these principles Steadfastly, especially when we want to take our will back:

"GOD, grant us knowledge that we may act according to Your Divine precepts. Instill in us a sense of Your purpose. Make us servants of Your will and grant us a bond of selflessness, that this may truly be Your work, not ours —in order that no addict, anywhere, need die from the horrors of addiction."

Have a blessed day
From an anonymous addict in NY

The Need for Our Traditions

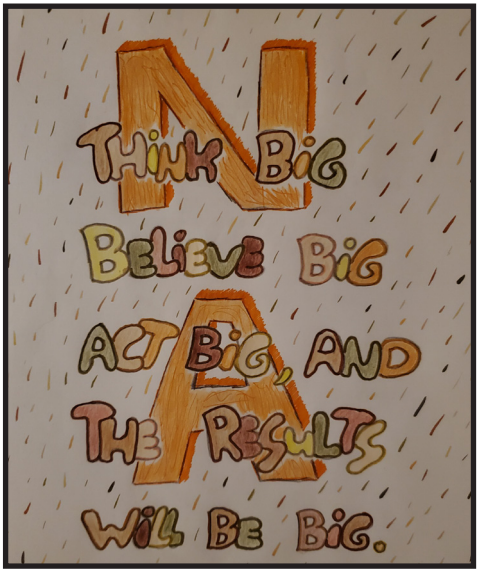
An NA Group without a conscience in an unconscious group. How many times have we gone to NA meetings where they either read the Tradition of the month or they don't read them at all? How many times have you had to look really hard for a clear NA message? How many times have you asked yourself, "Is this an NA Meeting?" How many times have you been unable to find an atmosphere of recovery? Too many. Here is why we need our Traditions.

From 1954 to 1959 there was basically one regular meeting and rabbit meetings. The one regular meeting took place at a Doctor Shrier's detox center. They nicknamed it "Shrier's Dryer" where people could go and dry out. Now Jimmy actually had a real problem with this particular meeting because you see they would go to the meeting and they would raise hands. All the alcoholics would raise their hands and then all the addicts would raise their hands. If there were more alcoholics it was an AA meeting and if there were more addicts it was an NA meeting. Jimmy was really big on the Traditions and he had a real problem with the way that this meeting was different each week depending on who was there.

Many NA groups were not following the 12 Traditions very closely. These groups were at times accepting money from outside entities, conflating AA with NA, or even adding religious elements to the meetings. NA Meetings began to decline because of the fact that you couldn't know if you were going to an AA meeting or a NA meeting and there was a 4-month period in the fall of 1959 when there

were no meetings held anywhere at all. It broke Jimmy's heart and we're not sure whether December, '59 or March, 1960, Jimmy K. determined that this couldn't be allowed to happen. Jimmy, Sylvia Wexler, and Penny Kennedy restarted Narcotics Anonymous and the vow they made was that they would follow the Traditions more closely. They felt that not following the Traditions is the reason it had faded away. The only way that they could survive as a fellowship is if they scrupulously followed the 12 Traditions, particularly the anonymity part.

I believe that here is one solution to help NA Groups to follow our Traditions. Take this blueprint of NA Group Conscience that my Homegroup wrote to help your Homegroup become or stay a conscious NA Group.



https://drive.google.com/open?id=165goHLwooxd76tYltUu-wSyF1ElKhyyDx

If we don't forget our history, we have a better chance of not repeating it.

From an anonymous addict in Pennsylvania

A step

A step can be used to describe length, growth, distance, process, progress, and direction.

A step inward, upward, a step back, one step at a time, step by step are all examples of the use of steps to describe movement.

Steps can be taken by individuals, groups, countries, and societies.

Some steps help achieve great success, some steps lead to disaster and destruction.

The most powerful steps turn into life changing events, miracles, and spiritual awakenings. I know of such Steps. They consist of 24 spiritual principles with the power to help dying and suffering addicts to find a new way to live. They're called the Program of

Narcotics Anonymous and they are free of charge. These steps are not something you take alone and they will take you to the Divine Power of Life.

By an anonymous addict in Sweden

Writing in NA

No, I am not going to write about writing step work. I am going to write about writing in general, what writing does for me and how it helps in my recovery.

I remember writing my first article for The New/Old NA Way magazine. A couple of years ago I started to get involved with people who all input and worked on this magazine. And it did something for me that I did not know beforehand.

At first, I felt insecure about what to write about. I needed someone to give me direction on what to write about. And then I was able to start writing a piece or input a bit on IP's that we were working on online together. It was nice to see your own input becoming part of a new piece of literature. It made me feel a certain kind of pride to be able to do this.

What I discovered was that I started to enjoy the process of writing. Sometimes a certain idea would pop up in my brain, and I could hear myself starting to write in my thoughts. That's where it starts, an idea. Sometimes it was just the outline of a story, or an idea on what to write about, or just 2 sentences. But I would write it down when I had the chance, and when I had time, I started working on it. At first it was really important for me how others would react. But over time this became less important. Because I started to enjoy the process, and what writing did for me. It helped me go deeper into my own thinking about a certain topic. Or it helped me get more understanding about a principle, or Tradition for example.

During all those hours of working on the magazine, putting all the articles and artwork together, I also started to enjoy the creativity of it all. To read everyone's ideas, to see the artwork or read the poems. There was a lot of creativity coming in, in different forms. And I love trying it all myself too. So, I got creative with writing, drawing, and now also making a comic. It is all fun for me, and it is fun to do together. It often starts in a conversation; you get an idea and the creative process starts. The rest is just putting some time and effort in, and I have had many moments that I really laughed about the results because you see your ideas come to life. In whatever form you choose to put your time and energy in, art, sentences, poems, etc.

It's just the same with everything in Narcotics Anonymous. When you start to get involved and start to say YES to whatever is put in front of you, you will learn about yourself. I found out that I could write, draw, be creative with others, make a flyer, etc. I found out I have talents, and creative ideas that can become something real. And I can also use this now in my job and wherever outside of NA. So, without NA I would not have found out that I was able to do these things. I have always been afraid to start doing something creative, I would shy away,

afraid to be judged or laughed at. I have faked my way through school, music classes, and always had an excuse to not do something or get through everything with as little effort as possible. It always kept me on the sideline, jealous of all the others that were doing what I was too afraid to do. So, I would judge them, and be negative about it all, pretending to not care or know better. A painful place to be in. I am grateful NA pulls me out of there if I open myself up for the opportunities that present themselves when I am willing.

I always hope people get involved and experience the feelings it gives when you are part of whatever creativity is going on. It is growth to me and learning. And without the creative freedom the Traditions give us, it would be a lifeless party no one wants to go to. So, consider this an invitation to start doing whatever you would like to do in NA, and see where it leads you.

By an anonymous addict in the Netherlands



19th Annual Fellowship Service

Conference for N.A.

When: June 28th thru June 30th, 2024

Where: Hamburg, PA

Place. Olivet Mountain Camp 1540 Mountain Ave.

Hamburg, Pa 19526

Cost: $125.00 per person

Price includes all meals {and lodging if needed}

There is no registration fee all money goes directly to pay for the facility and food

Write checks payable to Historical Perspective Group

For More Information: Contact Historical Perspective Group

(610) 428-9923 Ask for Ray: or e-mail **— matrixmatclub@yahoo.com**

Check Out Our Web www.nahelp.org/ **Send check to: A.S.I.S. For NA**

P.O. Box 4404 Allentown, Pa 18105 Write checks payable to

Historical Perspective Group of NA (Bring sheets, pillows, Towels, and soap everything else provided)

Name: _____ E - Mail: _____

Address: _____City _____State:

_____ Zip: _____ Phone Number (____) _____-

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Group Name_____ **Register by June 10, 2024**

Amount $125.00 Check NO _____

(Adversity does not build character, it Reveals it.) More Will Be Reveal

The Groups of Northern Columbiana County Area of Narcotics Anonymous present...

Annual 12-Step Retreat

February, 16,17,18, 2024

Das ***Dutch Village Inn***

150 East State Route 14

Columbiana, Ohio 44408

What to expect: Speakers, Discussion, Coffee,

Real NA Old School Recovery!

Only $5.00 for the weekend if you pre-register - $10.00 at the door

NO addict EVER turned away!

Pre-register by e-mailing stepretreat@yahoo.com

Rooms Check with the Hotel for the price per night for 2 adults ($10.00 additional for each adult)

Reserve your room by January 1, 2024, and mention you are with the NA Retreat to get the discounted price - Call 330-482-5050.

Upcoming Events

Annual 12 Step Retreat
Date: February 16th thru February 18th, 2024
Columbiana, Ohio

19th Annual Fellowship Service Conference for N.A.
Date: June 28th thru June 30th, 2024
Hamburg, PA

EFSC NETHERLANDS
Date: September 12th thru 15th , 2024
Ambt Delden, The Netherlands

Your event here? Send information to nahelp.org@gmail.com



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Please send your articles, event information, comics or other input to:

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Like it was when NA was new and young and life or death intense:
You matter to us so we will tell you the truth as we know it with nothing held back.

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"... so that no addict seeking recovery need ever die..."
We publish your input -- the opinions presented are not necessarily those of the New/Old NA Way or Anonymi Foundation